



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	27/04/2023	Time of Incident:	10:00am/12:00pm
Region / Directorate:	RMO – MWG	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Near Miss	EQSafe Incident Number:	31134/31243
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	TC Supervisor walks in live traffic lane and later in shift removes centreline cones, under free-flowing two-way traffic
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Executive Summary:

On the 27 April 2023 at approximately 10:00am after having given a Traffic Controller their scheduled break, the Traffic Management Team Leader proceeded to cross the live traffic lane over to the working lane without checking for oncoming traffic. The team leader only acknowledged there was traffic on approach when alerted by the Principal Contracting Supervisor, however proceeded to cross to the working lane in front of the approaching vehicles.

Approximately two hours later (12:00pm) road sealing works for that site location had been completed. The subcontracting road sealing workgroup cleaned the area, removing their road sealing machinery from the Airfield Road Intersection, allowing the subcontracting Traffic Control workgroup to remove the Traffic Management devices.

The Traffic Control Team Leader was removing the reflective delineators from the centreline, under reverse flow traffic management conditions with the portable traffic lights both on red. After realising the traffic lights had been on red for some time, the Team Leader contacted the traffic controllers, instructing them to release the traffic in both directions, without removing themselves from the centreline resulting in being exposed to live traffic with no escape route.



Photo of road where both Near Miss incidents occurred

Contributing Factors:	
• Failure by Traffic Management team leader to identify the line of fire hazard. • Procedure for the removal of the Traffic Guidance Scheme as per documented traffic management guidelines was not followed. • The Team Leader failed to consider their position on the centreline prior to sending traffic. • Principle Contractor relied on subcontractor to provide professional and experienced traffic management personnel to lead the traffic crew and did not confirm the subcontracting company had an adequate process in place for the selection of their team leaders.	
Corrective Actions:	
• Traffic management teams to review and understand the process for set up and removal of Traffic Guidance Schemes. • Ensure rules and regulations around Traffic Management are communicated. • Apply just culture model to the individual (as applicable). • Principal Contractor required to review and accept site leaders on the basis that the Subcontracting Traffic Management workgroup provides their process for the selection of Traffic Management Team Leaders, and/or the in-house training protocols.	
Additional Issues/Learnings:	
• Although there is a procedure for set-out and removal of traffic management devices, the crew leader failed to execute the sequence as described in supporting guidelines. Additionally, escape route was not maintained as the individual remained on the centre line of the road as live traffic was passing by in both directions either side. • Project management teams expect a certain level of expertise from appointed team leaders. Where engaging with subcontractors the same is applicable, and to ensure this level of expertise, a review process should be in place for the onboarding of all personnel to site. In this case a worker of only 8 months traffic management experience was appointed the position, holding the minimum BWTM/TC accreditations.	
 Critical Risk: This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to Interaction With Live Traffic.	
Distribution of Notice:	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations